

Mwangaza Academy - User Guide

How fee invoicing, M-Pesa paybill reconciliation and SMS receipts work in the school portal.

Revision 1 - July 2026 | Abdikarim, Frontend Developer & Freelancer

Where to go

School portal

<https://school-fees-portal-56m9.vercel.app>

Bursar and administrator screens for fee structures, invoices, payments and statements.

Sign-in details

Bursar / administrator

Access: Demo sign-in available on request

This portal holds school and pupil records, so a shared public password is not published here. Email me and I will send a time-limited demo account.

Please read: Unlike the other guides in this set, no credentials are printed here on purpose - the data model is school and pupil records, and a permanently public sign-in is not appropriate for that. Everything else in this guide describes the real product.

1. What the portal is for

Fee collection in most small and mid-sized Kenyan schools runs on a paybill number and a spreadsheet. A parent pays, the bursar reads the M-Pesa confirmation SMS, and types the amount against a pupil by hand. It works until it does not: a parent uses a sibling's admission number, someone pays one round figure across two children, or a transaction is entered twice at the end of a long day.

This portal takes the re-typing out. Parents pay to the school's paybill from their own phones, the payment is matched to a pupil automatically, and both the parent and the ledger are updated the moment it lands.

2. Fee structures and invoices

1. Open the fee structure screen and set the term's charges per class - tuition, transport, boarding, activity fees.
2. Generate invoices for the term. Every pupil in a class gets an invoice built from that class's structure.
3. Review the run before publishing. Individual invoices can be adjusted for bursaries, siblings' discounts or a mid-term admission.
4. Publish. Balances become visible and payments can be matched against them.

3. How a parent pays

1. The parent opens M-Pesa on their own phone and chooses Lipa na M-Pesa, then Pay Bill.
2. They enter the school's business number.
3. In the account number field they enter the pupil's admission number. This is the single most important field - it is what ties the money to the child.
4. They enter the amount and their PIN.
5. Safaricom notifies the portal, the payment is matched to the pupil, the balance updates, and an SMS receipt goes back to the parent.

Tell parents to use the admission number, not the pupil's name and not a phone number. A typo here is the main reason a payment needs a human to sort out.

4. The review queue

Some payments cannot be matched automatically - a mistyped admission number, a pupil who left, a parent paying for two children in one transaction. Those are never dropped and never guessed at.

1. Open the review queue. Each unmatched payment shows the M-Pesa details and a suggested pupil.
2. Accept the suggestion, or search for the right pupil.
3. Split a single payment across siblings where one transaction covers more than one child.
4. Confirm. The payment posts to the ledger and the receipt goes out.

5. Balances and statements

- A pupil's balance is calculated from their invoices and payments, never stored as a number someone can edit.
- Any figure on the dashboard drills back to the exact M-Pesa transaction that produced it, which is what makes a disputed balance a two-minute conversation.
- Statements are printable per pupil, per class or per term.
- Overpayments carry forward to the next term rather than needing a manual refund.

6. SMS notifications

- Receipts go out automatically on every matched payment.
- Arrears reminders can be sent to a whole class or to a filtered list of parents.
- Every message sent is logged against the pupil, so there is a record of who was told what and when.

7. If something goes wrong

- A parent's payment is not showing - check the review queue first. It is almost always an admission number typed wrong.

- A parent was charged twice - repeated notifications from Safaricom are ignored by design, so the same transaction can only post once. Check the transaction ID against the ledger.
- The SMS did not arrive - check the parent's number on the pupil record, then the message log.
- A balance looks wrong - open the statement. Every line is either an invoice or a payment, so the discrepancy is always visible.